

*First Baptist Church of Paducah*

# **Pastoral Care and Senior Outreach Policy**

*Adopted March 2024*

*Reviewed February 2026*

*Owner. Pastor James Whitlow*

2890 Broadway Street, Paducah, Kentucky, 42001.

This document sets forth the pastoral care and senior outreach commitments of the congregation of First Baptist Church of Paducah as adopted by the deacon board in March 2024 and reviewed by the deacon board in February 2026. It defines the care commitment cadence, the deacon assignment framework, the opt out handling protocol, the confidentiality expectations, and the communications authority governing correspondence sent on behalf of pastoral and committee leadership.

## **Section 1. Care Commitment Cadence**

The senior outreach and care commitment of First Baptist Paducah is expressed as a minimum contact cadence for every senior household on the coordinator maintained roster. The verbatim commitment adopted in March 2024 and reaffirmed in February 2026 is stated below.

*"One personal contact per calendar quarter for every active senior household. One personal contact per calendar month for every homebound senior household. A contact means a call, an in home visit, a card, or a face to face conversation at church. A newsletter alone does not count as a contact."*

The coordinator shall maintain the last contact date and last contact type in the roster for every senior household. Overdue households shall be reported to the committee at each monthly check in and to the committee chair at each quarterly close. Where a household is dually eligible for an active cadence and a homebound cadence during a given calendar year the more frequent cadence shall govern.

## **Section 2. Deacon Assignment**

The nine seated deacons of First Baptist Paducah are the primary visitation and care agents of the committee. Each deacon carries a coverage load of approximately twenty five to thirty senior households, balanced by geography where practicable and by prior relationship where the household has expressed a preference. The coordinator shall assign and rebalance the coverage annually and at any time a deacon rotates on or off the board.

Deacons shall log every contact through the coordinator maintained roster within three business days of the contact. Where a deacon is unable to complete a scheduled contact the deacon shall notify the coordinator so that a substitute contact may be arranged before the cadence window closes.

## **Section 3. Opt Out Handling**

Households may request removal from senior outreach in whole or in part. The committee honors such requests without qualification and treats reinstatement as a formal act requiring documentation. The verbatim protocol adopted in March 2024 is stated below.

*"Households that request removal from outreach must be removed from every list, including newsletter, automation, and visitation. Reinstatement requires a written request from the household. Verbal reports from third parties are not sufficient."*

A written request means a signed letter, a signed note in the church office intake basket, or an email from the household of record delivered to the volunteer coordinator or the pastor. A phone message from a family member other than the household of record shall be treated as an expression of family sentiment and shall not, on its own, alter the opt out standing of the household.

## **Section 4. Confidentiality**

Senior health information disclosed in the course of care shall not be shared outside the committee without the written consent of the senior or the senior's legally designated representative. Contact

frequency data may be shared with the deacon board to assess coverage and cadence compliance. Personal notes recorded in the roster shall remain with the coordinator and shall be summarized rather than shared verbatim when reported to the deacon board or to the committee.

Bereavement and pastoral counseling notes shall be maintained by the pastor. The committee may hold general knowledge of a bereavement flag on a household for the purpose of scheduling appropriate contacts but shall not hold detailed pastoral notes.

## **Section 5. Communications Authority**

The committee and the pastor recognize that correspondence sent on behalf of pastoral or committee leadership carries the moral weight of the office and shall not be issued without the explicit consent of the office holder. The verbatim policy adopted in March 2024 is stated below.

*"No communication, whether letter, email, text, or phone script, may be sent on behalf of the pastor or any committee chair without the explicit, recorded approval of that individual. Draft communications are permitted and encouraged. Sending is not."*

This policy applies to every channel through which committee or pastoral correspondence may be dispatched, including the church newsletter, the senior outreach automation, personal phone calls and text messages placed on behalf of the pastor or a chair, and any printed correspondence bearing the letterhead of the pastor or the committee.

## Appendix A. Committee Roster as of September 2026

The following persons hold seats on the Senior Outreach and Care Committee as of September 2026.

| Role                        | Name                                                |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Pastor                      | Pastor James Whitlow                                |
| Committee Chair             | Chad Lewis (chair since September 2026)             |
| Volunteer Coordinator       | Deb Prine                                           |
| Committee Treasurer Liaison | Wallace Grimes                                      |
| Committee Member            | Ruth Halbrook                                       |
| Committee Member            | Sam Ivy                                             |
| Committee Member            | Corine Latham                                       |
| Committee Member (Emeritus) | Marjorie Callahan (prior chair through August 2026) |

## Appendix B. Christmas Eve and New Year Eve Services 2026

The following schedule of services governs the December 2026 rota. The volunteer coordinator maintains the usher rota assignments in a separate roster and shall reconcile the rota with the reserve list prior to the November 3, 2026 committee meeting.

| Date                       | Time (CT) | Service             |
|----------------------------|-----------|---------------------|
| Thursday December 24, 2026 | 6:30 PM   | Family Service      |
| Thursday December 24, 2026 | 8:00 PM   | Traditional Service |
| Thursday December 24, 2026 | 10:30 PM  | Candlelight Service |
| Thursday December 31, 2026 | 7:00 PM   | Watchnight Service  |
| Thursday December 31, 2026 | 10:30 PM  | Candlelight Prayer  |

## Appendix C. Usher Rota Reserve List Acknowledgment

The reserve pool for the Christmas Eve and New Year Eve services is maintained separately by the volunteer coordinator on the committee rota roster. The committee chair shall coordinate with the volunteer coordinator to identify fills for any unfilled rota slot in advance of the November 3, 2026 committee meeting. The first and third Sunday regular ushers shall not be asked to carry additional slots at the December services except by their own offer.